

Video

Review

Section IV



Words of Warning-YOU DON'T KNOW WHAT YOU'VE GOT 'TIL IT'S GONE

- Zeno(450 BC), said we need to be “living in agreement with nature”
- **Ecology:** relationship between organisms & their physical environment
- cleanliness of air is a longstanding concern
 - King Edward I banned it, then Britain's & U.S.' Clean Air Acts
- 19th-century writers showed off nature spurred some early activist groups & U.S. national parks
- Rachel Carson wrote Silent Spring(1962)
 - Said “how DDT entered the food chain & accumulated in the fatty tissues of animals, including human beings, & caused cancer & genetic damage”
- DDT was banned(People realized how much we affect Earth)
- Ron Cobb made an “ecology” symbol (1969)
- Earth Day (4/22/1970)



Paving Paradise-Listening Guide 9: “Big Yellow Taxi” – 1970 Joni Mitchell

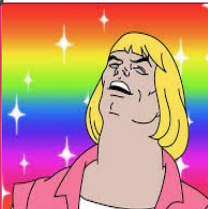
- Joni Mitchell made music
 - Siquomb Publishing - published her work
 - “*Joni Mitchell (Song to a Seagull)*”[1968]
 - *Clouds* rose to Number 31 on Billboard
- *Ladies of the Canyon* was more diverse(included “*Big Yellow Taxi*”)
 - Referenced how Hawaii’s nature is being removed so infrastructure can be built
 - Folk → Rock(still used Acoustic Guitar)
 - “bop vocal” is multi-tracking
 - Verse-Chorus form
 - changes harmonies in each chorus
 - Mitchell says it’s a “nursery rhyme,” but also a “good little workhouse of a song”
 - covered 575 times & BMI recognized it for reaching one million performances



POISON IS THE WIND THAT BLOWS-Listening Guide

10: “Mercy Mercy Me (The Ecology)” – 1971 Marvin Gaye

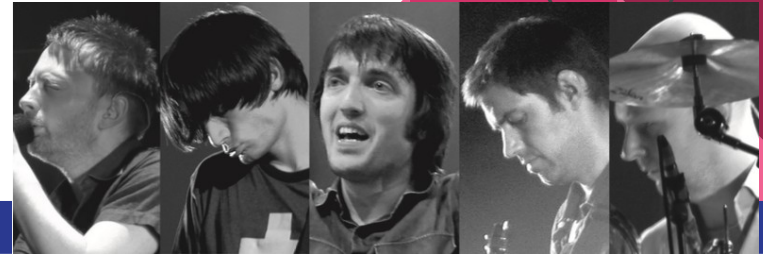
- 1970s: environmental & social messages in music got popular
 - Marvin Gaye wanted to record protest songs, but Gordy thought it would damage his career
- Motown Records(1959): producing major stars
- Gaye’s *I Heard It Through the Grapevine*(1968) was #1 for 7 weeks
- Gordy blocked *What’s Going On*(1971)(released without Gordy’s approval)
 - addressed war, peace, ecology, & social justice, blending R&B w/ gospel influences
 - introduced multi-tracked vocals & listing lyrics & musicians on the cover
- *Mercy Mercy Me (The Ecology)* & *Inner City Blues (Make Me Wanna Holler)* became popular hit singles
 - Marvin Gaye was one of the first R&B artists to address environmental issues in a song
 - only track on *What’s Going On* written solely by Gaye
 - straightforward strophic, but unique instruments
 - In 2002, *Mercy Mercy Me (The Ecology)* was inducted into Grammy Hall of Fame



POST-MODERN ANXIETY - Listening Guide 11: “Idioteque” – 2000

Radiohead: Thomas Yorke; Philip Selway; Edward O’Brien; Colin Greenwood; Jonathan Greenwood / Paul Lansky

- “Idioteque”(2000) environmental themes & technological experimentation
- Radiohead(mid-80s): Thom Yorke, Phil Selway, Ed O’Brien, Colin Greenwood, & Jonny Greenwood
- “Creep”(1993) became their 1st American hit
 - grunge → weirder w/ *The Bends* (1995) & *OK Computer* (1997)
 - *OK Computer* won Best Alternative Music Album(1998)
 - Nigel Godrich suggested splitting into groups to experiment w/ electrophones
- led to *Kid A* (2000) & *Amnesiac* (2001)
- old synthesizers, radio noise & record (unclear about its genre)
- Paul Lansky used Richard Wagner’s “Tristan chord” in *mild und leise*(1973)
 - Lansky is a co-author
- Everything is completely misaligned
- Yorke’s lyrics talk about fear for the future



CALLING FOR ACTION-LISTENING COMPANION 12:

“Despite Repeated Warnings” (2018) – Paul McCartney

- Paul McCartney: a member of The Beatles
 - started by covering American songs but began writing originals
 - *Please Please Me* (1963), featuring eight original songs
 - *Sgt. Pepper's Lonely Hearts Club Band* (1967): 32 million copies sold
- solo album *McCartney* (1970), featuring *Maybe I'm Amazed*
- *Egypt Station* (2018) became his 1st album to debut at No. 1 in 36 years
 - Inspired by a newspaper article about climate change & political inaction
- Uses a symbolic sea captain steering a ship toward icebergs, representing climate change denial
- multi-section symphonic rock, shifting between ballad, blues-rock, & driving rock
- unexpected harmonic shifts (chromatic mediants)
- Aims to raise awareness that climate change is real & prevent reckless

leadership

Why Don't We Listen?-LISTENING COMPANION 13: “Feels Like Summer” (2018) – Donald Glover [“Childish Gambino”]

- people are ignorant bc we are distracted
- award for “Redbone” for a song in *Get Out*(2018)
- Premier of *This is America* on SNL(1st #1 on *Billboard*)
- two-track EP *Summer Pack*
- “Summertime Magic”:
 - Happy-go-lucky(Different from “Feels Like Summer”)
- darker message about overpopulation & loss of control
- Chorus expresses hope but ends in resignation
- explicitly mentions climate issues
- Word-painting
- music video overshadowed the song’s environmental message



IS IT TOO LATE?-Listening Guide 14: Elegy for the Arctic – 2016 Ludovico Einaudi

- *The Tempo Project* (2020): Dr. Lucy Jones-use music to change sentiment around climate change & inspire action
- Jones made *In Nomine Terra Calens*(138 years of Earth's temperature data)
 - final note represents uncertain future of Earth
- *Elegy for the Arctic* (2016):Ludovico Einaudi-commissioned by Greenpeace to raise awareness about Arctic's damage
 - Premiered on a floating piano in Arctic Sea with Arctic Sunrise ship
 - reflects sorrow for ecological harm already done to Arctic, especially through F minor
- Although Greenpeace's campaign to create a sanctuary was blocked, has been viewed over 20 million times
- Greenpeace collected 8M messages supporting creation of a sanctuary for Arctic
- Greenpeace remains determined to continue advocating for Arctic